

Then there's the AI. I'm still waiting for that 'agentic' future we saw in the demos. But the tools we actually have right now have moved past being just party tricks. Here are some of the things I found really useful.

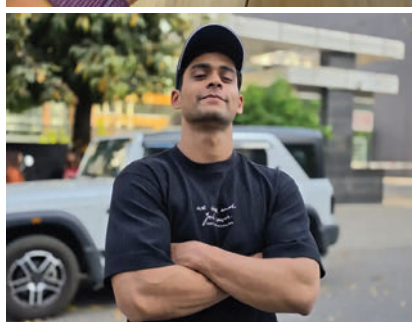
- **Samsung Voice Recorder:** This is the best voice recorder app on any phone, period. I recently recorded an 18-minute interview on the S26 Ultra, and it transcribed the whole thing, separated the speakers perfectly, and allowed me to export the text in seconds. Basically, with this phone, I don't need to create different Google accounts just to log in to Otter.ai for transcription purposes. Everything is sorted natively on this phone.
- **Photo Assist:** This is a much better implementation of Generative Edit. It's faster and the 'Creative Studio' mode can actually turn my rough S Pen doodles into usable art.
- **AI Select:** While I still mostly use Circle to Search to find information, I've also started to use AI Select a lot to take action on my screen content. In One UI 8.5, paired with the S Pen, AI Select is my one-stop tool to capture, edit and extract content for immediate use.

Which reminds me, the S Pen is also back in my daily routine. And not just for the AI Select stuff, but with the S26 Ultra, I'm back to signing PDFs and taking handwritten notes. More natural.

My one major gripe with the software? Samsung, why is there still no native app locker? Secure Folder exists and it's a cool privacy feature to have. But it's kind of an overkill for when I just want a simple fingerprint on my personal apps. It's the one missing piece in an otherwise perfect software experience on any smartphone out there.

CAMERA: STILL THE KING OF VERSATILITY

I've been genuinely impressed with how Samsung has handled the tuning on the Galaxy S26 Ultra. As for the hardware, we are looking at a 200MP main, 50MP



ultra-wide, 50MP 5x telephoto and a 10MP 3x telephoto. For selfies, there's a 12MP front camera.

Now, in the last year or two, we've seen brands like Vivo and Xiaomi really dial it in with their still photography, but there's a consistency here with the Samsung. In fact, even with my iPhone 17 Pro Max. This consistency, I feel, still makes them the default, safe choice for most people.

I personally love that punchy vibrancy Samsung brings to the table, along with a slightly cooler white balance that makes the images pop. I've been looking at comparison shots from both, and honestly, you can't go wrong with either. It really just comes down to your personal aesthetic.

On the video front, it's a bit of a split decision. Samsung's Horizon Lock stabilisation is magical and it's legitimately unlike anything I've seen on another phone. It stays level even when things get shaky. However, if I'm being honest, the iPhone 17 Pro Max is still my go-to for video in a general scenario. There's

just a gold standard feel to how iPhones handle overall video recording, especially the lens switching, that Android phones haven't quite mastered yet.

FINAL VERDICT

If you're coming from an S24 Ultra or older, you're going to appreciate the attention to detail and the upgrades on the Galaxy S26 Ultra. Guaranteed.

—Aman Rashid

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 8 Elite Gen 5 | Display: 6.9-inch Quad HD+ 10-bit panel | Refresh Rate: 120 Hz | Memory: 12/16 GB | Storage: 256/512/1024 GB | Battery: 5000 mAh | Charging: 60W wired | OS: One UI 8.5 | Cameras (Rear): 200 MP + 50 MP + 60 MP + 10 MP | Camera (Front): 12 MP

CONTACT

Company: Samsung | Phone: 1-800-5-726-7864 | Email: Web form | Website: www.samsung.com/in/

Read more on Digit.in:
tinyurl.com/8wehs12